
TCET Coding Platform

Student User Guide

Version 1.0

Getting Started, Practising & Progressing

Powered by

Centre of Excellence (CoE), TCET

Document type Student-facing operational guide

Scope Account setup, practice, contests, rankings, profile analytics

Audience TCET students using the Coding Platform

Status Version 1.0

July 30, 2026

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Chapter 1

Welcome to the Platform

1.1 Purpose of this Guide

The TCET Coding Platform is the institution's environment for programming practice, timed contests, and progress tracking. This guide takes a student from a first visit to a complete profile and then explains how to practise, participate in contests, read rankings, and use personal performance reports.

The guide describes the student experience only. Faculty tools for creating problems and managing contests are intentionally outside its scope.

1.2 What You Can Do

After your profile is complete, the platform gives you one place to:

- browse curated practice problems and solve them in supported languages;
- register for eligible upcoming contests and take timed assessments;
- view problem ratings and eligible published contest standings; and
- track your rank, accuracy, solved problems, language use, and submission activity.

| Before you begin

Use your active TCET/CoE identity. The Coding Platform does not create or store a separate password. Sign-in and sign-out are handled through the Centre of Excellence (CoE) single sign-on service.

1.3 Navigation at a Glance

Area	Use it to
Dashboard	See current activity, performance measures, recent submissions, recommended practice, and contests that need attention.
Problems	Search and filter the practice archive, open a challenge, run code, and submit a solution.
Contests	Register for a contest, check its schedule, enter an eligible attempt, and open released reports.
Leaderboard	Compare problem ratings or published contest standings with department and year filters.
Profile	Review academic identity and performance analytics; edit permitted profile data and print a report card.

Chapter 2

Sign In and Create Your Profile

2.1 Sign In Through CoE

1. Open the TCET Coding Platform landing page.
2. Select **Sign In**. You are redirected to the CoE sign-in page.
3. Sign in with your authorised TCET/CoE account. Follow the CoE page if it asks you to register for access or complete its own login process.
4. Return to the Coding Platform after successful sign-in. New students are taken to **Complete Your Profile**; returning students with a valid profile go to the dashboard.

Note. Do not share your CoE credentials or leave a signed-in session unattended on a shared computer. Use the account menu to sign out when you finish.

2.2 Complete Your Student Profile

The platform requires a complete, valid profile before it permits student features such as practice, contests, rankings, and analytics. Enter the following information carefully, then select **Save & Continue**.

Field	Required	How it is used
Name	Yes	Displayed across your student profile and rankings. Use your full, recognisable name.
UID	Yes	Identifies your academic batch details. The platform derives your roll number from this value.
Department	Yes	Used for profile information and department-specific leaderboard filters or contest eligibility.
Semester	Yes	Records your current semester; choose a value from 1 to 8.
LinkedIn URL	No	An optional professional-profile link. Enter a complete URL beginning with <code>http://</code> or <code>https://</code> .
GitHub URL	No	An optional code-profile link. Enter a complete URL beginning with <code>http://</code> or <code>https://</code> .

2.3 Enter Your UID Correctly

Your UID follows this pattern:

admission-year - branch + division + roll-number - passout-year

For example, 24-AIDSA51-28 means admission year 24, branch AIDS, division A, roll number 51, and passout year 28. Use uppercase letters. The platform reads the UID and automatically derives the roll number; you do not enter a separate roll-number field.

| Profile validation

The profile cannot be completed with a blank, placeholder, or incorrectly formatted UID. If the form highlights a field, correct that field before saving. The UID should represent your real academic identity.

2.4 What Happens Next

When the profile saves successfully, you are sent to the student dashboard. Your profile card will show the **Profile Complete** status. If your profile is incomplete later, the platform redirects you back to the profile-completion page before allowing access to student areas.

Chapter 3

Use the Dashboard

3.1 Start from the Dashboard

The dashboard is your daily starting point. Use **Start Solving** to go directly to the problem archive or **Leaderboard** to review rankings. It also brings attention to a live contest or the next contest for which you can still register.

3.2 Read Your Key Measures

Measure	Meaning
Problems Solved	Number of practice problems you have solved.
Submissions	Number of submissions recorded for your account.
Current Rank	Your current position in the problem-rating leaderboard; it can be unavailable before ranking data exists.
Accuracy	Accepted submissions as a percentage of your total submissions.

3.3 Use Recent Activity

The dashboard lists recent practice submissions with language, time, and verdict. It can also surface recommended unsolved problems and current live, upcoming, or recent contests. Use **View all** to open the full Problems or Contests pages.

Chapter 4

Practise with Problems

4.1 Find a Problem

Open **Problems** from the navigation. The archive supports a search box and filters so you can build a focused practice session.

- Search by a problem title or relevant text.
- Filter by progress status: all, unsolved, attempted, or solved.
- Select one or more difficulty levels: Easy, Medium, or Hard.
- Select available topic tags to focus on a subject area.
- Clear filters to return to the full archive.

Each problem card shows its title, difficulty, topic tags, and your current status. Select **Solve Challenge** to open the full problem.

4.2 Read Before You Code

On the problem page, read the statement, input and output requirements, constraints, examples, and any language-specific limits. Choose a programming language in the editor before writing your solution. Start with sample cases, but ensure your algorithm also handles the stated constraints and unseen cases.

4.3 Run and Submit

1. Write your solution in the editor and select the required language.
2. Select **Run** to test against available sample or custom input.
3. Review compiler messages, output, runtime, and memory information. Fix issues and run again as needed.
4. Select **Submit** when your solution is ready for evaluation.
5. Wait for processing to finish. The platform shows a pending state while queued or running, then displays the final verdict.

4.4 Understand Submission Results

Verdict	What to do
Accepted	Your solution passed the required tests. Your solved-problem and profile statistics update from accepted activity.
Wrong Answer	Re-check edge cases, output formatting, and the algorithm's logic.
Time Limit Exceeded	Improve time complexity or remove avoidable repeated work.
Runtime Error	Check bounds, null or empty cases, recursion depth, and language-specific runtime behaviour.
Compilation Error	Read the compiler output, then correct syntax, imports, type usage, or language selection.
Internal Error or delayed processing	Keep the page open briefly and retry only after the result settles. If it persists, note the problem and time, then contact CoE/TCET support.

A good practice loop

Choose an appropriate difficulty, solve independently, run focused tests, submit, read the verdict, and revisit the problem after learning from mistakes. Consistent practice matters more than attempting many problems without review.

Chapter 5

Register for and Take Contests

5.1 Register from Either Entry Point

You can register from the dashboard's highlighted contest card or from **Contests**. The Contests page separates **Live Contests**, **Upcoming Contests**, and **Past Contests**.

1. Find the contest and confirm its start time, duration, and registration status.
2. Select **Register** or **Register Now** while registration is open.
3. Wait for the confirmation message. The card changes to show that you are registered.
4. Before the contest begins, use **View Details** to review information and return when it is live.

Registration may be unavailable because it has not opened, has closed, or the contest is not available to your academic group. A closed registration cannot be bypassed from the student interface.

5.2 Enter an Attempt

When a registered contest is live, select **Enter Contest**. Start only when you are ready to work: your attempt has a personal timer and is also bounded by the contest's closing time. The contest may contain coding questions, multiple-choice questions, or multiple-select questions.

| Before entering

Use a stable internet connection, close unrelated tabs and applications, and make sure you have enough uninterrupted time. Read the contest instructions before beginning. The displayed timer is authoritative for your attempt.

5.3 During a Contest

- Work through questions using the contest navigation and keep an eye on the timer.
- Save answers and code as you progress. Coding drafts are saved automatically while you work.
- Submit before the timer reaches zero whenever possible.
- If time expires, unfinished saved work can be auto-submitted at the deadline. Treat this as a safety net, not a substitute for reviewing your submission.

5.4 Academic Integrity and Results

Timed contests use browser-level integrity controls. Actions that violate contest rules can be recorded as proctoring events and may incur penalties. At the configured limit, the platform can submit the attempt automatically.

Do not seek external help, copy answers, communicate about the contest, or attempt to bypass browser or platform controls. After you submit, or the system auto-submits, answers are locked. For live contests, scores, correct answers, and rank are deliberately hidden. Results appear only after the contest has ended and faculty publish them. A past contest can show **View Report**; where required, complete the displayed feedback step before opening the report.

Chapter 6

Read the Leaderboard

6.1 Choose a Leaderboard Mode

Open **Leaderboard** and select one of the two modes:

- **Problem:** shows the platform's problem-rating standings, including solved count, score, and accuracy.
- **Contest:** shows standings for a selected contest that you attempted and whose results have been published.

6.2 Apply Filters and Read Empty States

Use **Department** and **Year** filters to narrow results. In Contest mode, choose an available contest first, then apply the same filters. Your own row is highlighted when it appears in the table.

Contest standings are intentionally unavailable if you did not attempt the contest or if results have not yet been published. This protects the fairness of ongoing assessment. Return after the organiser has published results.

Chapter 7

Use Your Academic Profile Dashboard

7.1 Review Your Identity and Status

Open **Profile** to view your Academic Profile Dashboard. The identity card displays your name, email, UID, derived roll number, department, semester, and optional GitHub and LinkedIn links. The status badge indicates whether the profile is complete.

7.2 Update Permitted Information

Select **Edit Profile** to update your semester and optional LinkedIn or GitHub URLs. Use complete web addresses beginning with `http://` or `https://`. Contact CoE/TCET support if an identity or UID correction is needed.

7.3 Interpret the Performance Snapshot

Panel	How to read it
Global Rank	Current position in the problem-rating leaderboard. It may show N/A before a rank is available.
Total Solved	Problems successfully solved.
Accepted	Number of accepted submissions.
Accuracy	Share of submissions that were accepted, shown as a percentage.
Problem Difficulty	Distribution of solved problems across Easy, Medium, and Hard levels.
Language Proficiency	Number of submissions made in each programming language; it represents activity, not a formal certification.
Submission Trend	Submissions grouped over time. Use it to observe consistency.
Progress Over Time	Cumulative first-time solves together with recent submission activity.
Estimated Active Time	An estimate inferred from submission activity, not a measured log of every minute spent coding.
Submission Activity	A calendar-style view of days on which submissions were made.
Submission History	A list of problem, language, status, date, and a View Code action for recorded submissions.

7.4 Print or Save Your Report Card

Use **Download Report Card** where it is available. The platform opens a print-friendly report containing identity information, summary measures, difficulty and language breakdowns, and recent submission history. In the print dialogue, choose a printer or select **Save as PDF**. Review the content before sharing it, especially when using a shared device.

Chapter 8

Troubleshooting and Good Practice

8.1 Common Situations

Situation	Recommended action
I cannot sign in.	Confirm that you are using an active authorised TCET/CoE account. Complete any required CoE login or access-registration step, then try again.
I keep returning to Complete Your Profile.	Complete every required field, especially the real UID in the required format, then save the profile successfully.
My UID is rejected.	Check uppercase letters, hyphens, branch, division, roll number, and passout year. Example: 24-AIDSA51-28.
I cannot register for a contest.	Check whether registration has not opened, is closed, or the contest is unavailable to your academic group.
I cannot see contest results.	Confirm that you attempted the contest and that results have been published. Complete requested feedback before the report if prompted.
My submission is still processing.	Allow time for evaluation to finish and avoid repeated submissions. If it remains unresolved, note the problem, approximate time, and visible message before seeking help.
My profile has no charts yet.	This is normal until you submit solutions. Begin with practice problems; analytics populate from recorded activity.

8.2 Keep Your Account and Work Safe

- Never share CoE credentials, session links, contest answers, or personal report cards unnecessarily.
- Sign out after using a shared or public computer.
- Keep LinkedIn and GitHub links professional and current; leave them blank if you prefer not to publish them.
- For support, provide only the details needed to investigate: your name or UID, the page or contest, the approximate time, and the exact visible error. Do not send passwords.

8.3 Get Help

For persistent sign-in, profile, submission, or contest-access issues, contact the CoE/TCET support team or the relevant contest organiser. Include a concise description of what you were

doing and what happened. For time-sensitive contest incidents, report the issue immediately and follow the organiser's instructions.

| Your next step

Complete your profile, solve one suitable practice problem, then return to the Profile dashboard to see your first activity recorded. Regular, honest practice is the most reliable route to stronger rankings and contest performance.